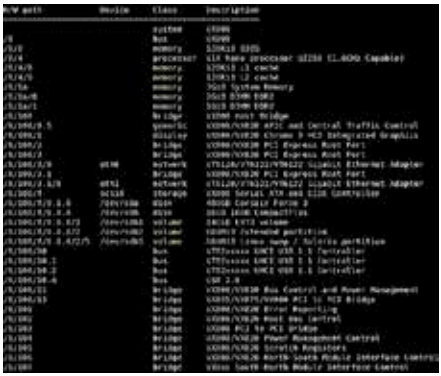
Basics

You need to have a good understanding of what your computer is made up of, the hardware and the software. By this we do not mean in-depth knowledge of how it all works together but, the ability to identify parts, their functions and which part of the operating system controls those parts.

***Tools tip:** You can use the 'lshw' command is used to show all the hardware information of the system.*

In the Linux OS, you should be familiar with the terminal functions and the directory structure and its functioning. Most important of all, you should be familiar with configuration and log files, as a lot of issues could be resolved through configuration and the log files help you trace the source of the issue.



The 'lshw' command lists the hardware information

Into the unknown

This is where most of us step back, new territory. Remember, there will always be something new to learn everyday and unless you start to experiment with new knowledge, you will not learn anything new. Besides, if you ignore the problem, it won't go away but it'll become even worse. So it is better that you tackle it head-on and learn something new in the process which will go a long way in making you one of the pros. Do not forget, all the Linux pros out there were someday as clueless as a newbie, they learnt everything they know through experimentation.

All that you have to be careful with is logging everything that you do. This is just to ensure that in case if there are any unwanted results by your experimenting, you can always retrace your steps and revert the changes. By the end of your exploration or experimentation, call it what you want, you will have gained a lot more knowledge and confidence with operating the system.